

King rag worm Unlike earthworms, king rag worms have separate male and female sexes. These worms live on the seashore and die after they have mated.



Garden snail Hermaphrodite snails court each other before mating. They shoot each other with tiny needles called love darts. The darts help boost the transfer of sperm.



Angelfish Marine angelfish have both male and female sex organs—but not at the same time. They are born female but change into males as they grow older—usually when an old male dies and another takes over its territory.



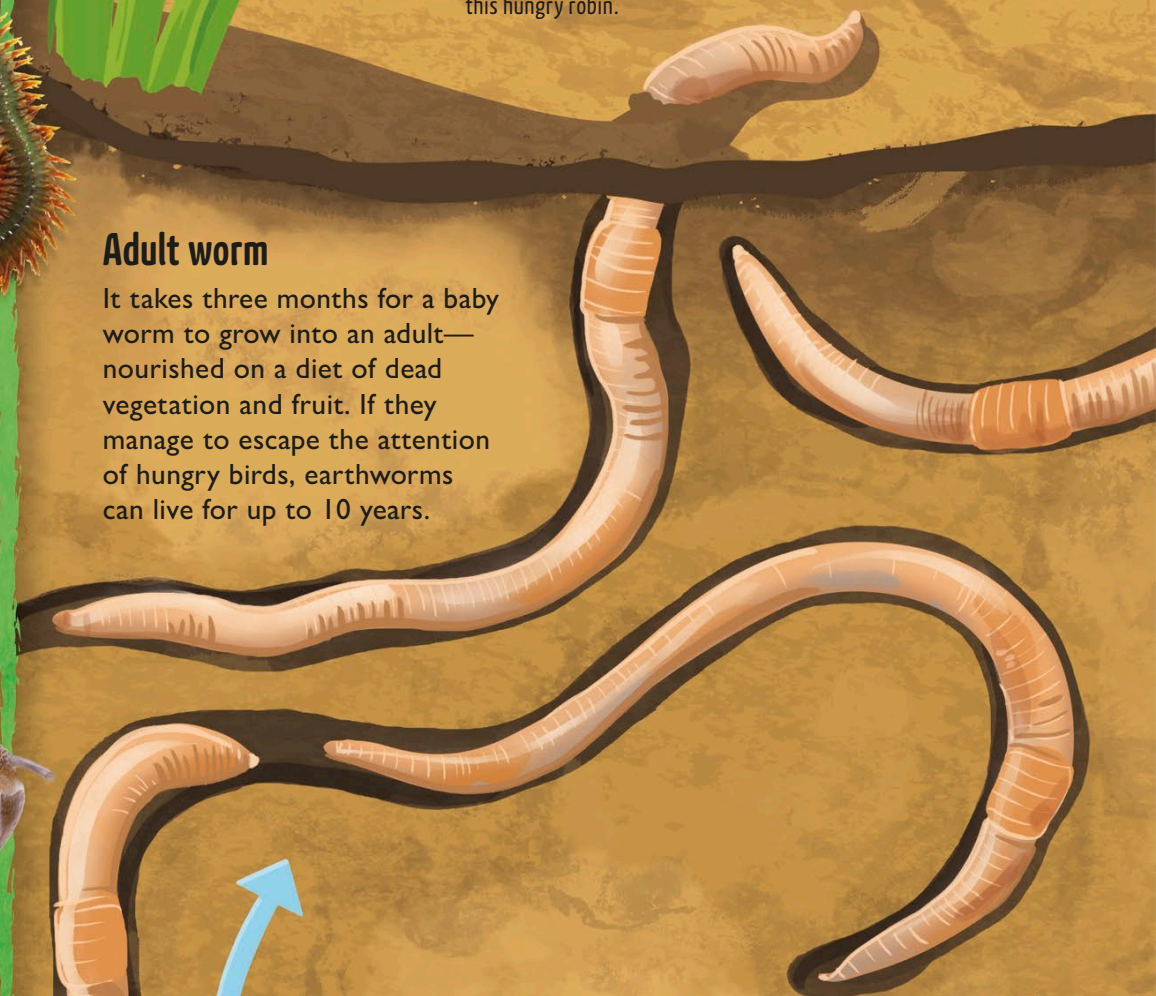
Earthworms make a tasty snack for all kinds of birds, such as this hungry robin.



Common earthworms are nicknamed “night crawlers” because they come to the surface at night to collect dead leaves to eat.

Adult worm

It takes three months for a baby worm to grow into an adult—nourished on a diet of dead vegetation and fruit. If they manage to escape the attention of hungry birds, earthworms can live for up to 10 years.



Hatching

The cocoon, which is about the same size as a grape seed, develops a hardened casing. It contains up to 20 fertilized eggs. However, only a few of these grow into baby worms, which hatch after three to six months.

